



December 20, 2024

Eric J Dobratz, M.D.
SNGH River Pavilion, Suite 1100
600 Gresham Drive
Norfolk, VA 23507

RE: IRB # 24-12-NH-0285

Current Status and Future Trends in the Rural and Urban Otolaryngology Workforce

Dear Dr. Dobratz:

Thank you for sending the above request to the Human Subjects' Protection Program (HSPP) for review.

The Federal definition of research is "A systematic investigation, including research development, testing and evaluation, designed to develop or contribute to generalizable knowledge."

The Federal definition of human subject is "a living individual about whom an investigator conducting research obtains: (1) data through intervention or interaction with the individual, or (2) identifiable private information" 45CFR46.102 (f).

The IRB's charge is to review Human Subjects Research, including some situations where studies may be exempt.



The HSPP has reviewed the request for your project and has determined that this project **does not involve human subjects** and therefore does not meet the definition of Human Subjects Research as described above. As such, it is not subject to IRB review.

When submitting a publication or presentation the IRB review of this project can be verified by providing this letter if necessary.

Should there be any changes to the methodology or procedures to this important project, please submit those changes to the IRB for review prior to implementation.

Thank you for your continued cooperation with the Institutional Review Board.

Sincerely,

Daniel M. Sullivan, PhD
Assistant Director, Human Subjects Protection Program

DMS/ja